

film review **Ghost Buster**

BHOOTHNATH

Director: Vivek Sharma
Starring: Amitabh Bachchan, Aman Siddique, Juhi Chawla

His mother may be feeding him all sorts of comfort food (think of the in-film product placements!) but that doesn't stop Aman Siddique from being a sharp customer. He plays a boy naughty enough to scare a crusty old ghost and Amitabh Bachchan plays a troubled spirit who refuses to let anyone occupy his home. Everyone knows how the movie will pan out—this is not, after all, a Ram Gopal Varma *ka bhoot*. But there is a certain charm in the scenes between the boy and the ghost. The boy helps him brush his teeth, clip his nails, and wear smart Reid & Taylor jackets. The ghost in turn teaches the little terror about loving and



A BIT OF A DRAG: A posterplay of *Bhoothnath*

forgiving. Art director Munish Sappel is clearly inspired by Vishal Bhardwaj's *Makdee*, and everyone—including an outrageous Satish Shah playing a tiffin-stealing principal—keeps everything going cracklingly. Until the ghost of *Baghban* (which afflicted another Ravi Chopra production, *Baabul*) strikes and many tear-inducing homilies have to be rendered about loving your parents. The first half will

make children laugh and the second half will make the parents weep silently into their handkerchiefs. Something for everyone but an opportunity to create a memorable children's character is clearly lost. Speaking of children, what are parents feeding them to produce such prodigious talents as Darsheel Safary and Siddique? There are some A-list actors who need to go on that diet.

by Kaveree Bamzai

recommendations **Beautiful Moulds**

KOLKATA On May 24, Srijan will be organising a summertime poetry grove, where poet Zilka Joseph, who is originally from Kolkata but is now settled in the US, will be reading her poetry. The theme of the evening will be alienation. Joseph recently won the Elsie Choy Lee Scholarship (2008-2009) from the Centre for the Education of Women, University of Michigan.

by Elora Sen



A sculpture on display

BANGALORE Gallery Sumukha will host a sculpture workshop from May 17 to 23. The purpose of the workshop is to involve the viewer and the patron in the process of creation of works of art. Renowned sculptors from across the country have been invited to participate in the workshop. Well-known artistes who work in mediums ranging from terracotta to wood, fibreglass and ceramic will create sculptures initially in clay, which would later be cast in bronze. Some of the artistes at the camp include Laxmi Goud, Shanthi Swaroopini, Venkat Bothsa, Alex Mathew, N.N. Rimzon, Thomas Kovoar, G. Reghu and S. Gopinath.

by Nirmala Ravindran

music **Strings of Honour**

DELHI Sarangi maestro Ustad Sabri Khan occupies a unique place in the history of Hindustani classical music. He was one of the few musicians who not only accompanied artistes to various concerts but also worked tirelessly to give sarangi a solo status on such platforms. He nurtured the *guru-shishya parampara* and prepared next generation musicians such as Swarnima, Shaminder Pal Singh, Suhail Yusuf Khan and Kamal Sabri. To mark his 80th birth anniversary, the Saurang Sangeet Society has organised a three-day



MUSICAL DUO: Swarnima (left); Suhail Yusuf Khan

music and dance festival from May 23 to 25. Day one will feature a vocal recital by Swarnima followed by Ustad Zamir Ahmed Khan on sarangi. On the second day his disciples, Singh, Yusuf Khan and Aslam Khan will pay tribute to the



legendary artiste through their sarangi performances. The final day will feature kathak by Mahua Shankar, vocal recital by Ustad Mazhar Ali and Ustad Jawad Ali Khan. At India Habitat Centre.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit